

## Learning contract

### Preamble

Learning to code is not only about learning a technical language; it is about learning a way of thinking. By enrolling in this program, it is expected that you commit to learning the steps involved in understanding a problem, breaking it down, researching possible solutions, testing different approaches, and understanding why something works or does not work. Debugging is an important part of this process: before fixing a problem, you need to be able to identify and describe it clearly. Coding is constantly evolving, and you will never know everything or follow exactly the same process twice. The goal is therefore not necessarily and strictly to learn *how to do something*, or to produce a working result, but to learn *how to find out how to do it and understand what you are doing*. This process can be challenging, and that challenge is an essential part of learning.

### Use of LLMs (AI) policy

AI tools can support your learning when they help you understand concepts, errors, and possible approaches. Nonetheless, they should not obfuscate the learning process by generating project structures or solutions that you cannot explain or take ownership of. You are expected to be the author of your code and projects: this does not mean writing “every character” yourself, but being able to understand and take responsibility and authorship for what you produce. Understanding does not require memorising every keyword or piece of syntax; it means being able to explain how your project works, what its main components do, and how changes in code, data, or interaction produce the resulting output.

#### Acceptable uses of AI:

- *Asking for explanations of concepts (e.g. variables, functions, async behavior).*
- *Asking why an error occurs or why something does not behave as expected.*
- *Requesting explanations of what existing code does, step by step.*
- *Asking editorial output, or auditing your code against other technical alternatives.*

#### Unacceptable uses of AI:

- *Asking AI to design or generate independent features and copying-pasting them in your project.*
- *Asking AI to produce tutorials you intend to present in class.*
- *Having AI to generate structures of your project.*
- *Using AI to write blocks of code that you cannot explain afterwards.*

I declare to understand, agree and act in accordance with the guidelines previously mentioned. I understand that not doing so might negatively impact my assessment.